



The Honourable Senator Strickland
2025
California State Senate
1021 O Street
Sacramento, CA 95814

November 18th,

Dear Senator Strickland,

On behalf of the League of California Cities, we are pleased to express our support for SB 06, the Affordable Housing Flexibility Act of 2025. This legislation represents an important advancement in empowering local governments to address California's affordable housing challenges in a manner that respects local planning authority, infrastructure realities, and community character.

Cities throughout California remain committed to contributing to the state's housing goals, yet one-size-fits-all statewide mandates, particularly those requiring high density development, often fail to align with local conditions or community input. SB 06 responds thoughtfully to these concerns by offering a voluntary, locally controlled framework that allows jurisdictions to permit low density, below market rate housing through streamlined zoning and approval processes, without imposing additional state requirements. This approach strengthens local capacity to deliver affordable housing by enabling small scale, neighborhood-compatible types such as duplexes, triplexes, townhomes, and other low rise forms identified in the bill.

The League particularly appreciates that SB 06 ensures qualifying projects may be approved through modified or ministerial procedures at the local level while shielding them from additional state level discretionary review. By doing so, the bill supports efficient and predictable approvals while keeping control in the hands of cities and counties. Moreover, SB 06 allows units approved under this framework to count toward a jurisdiction's Regional Housing Needs Allocation obligations when they meet established requirements, providing an important incentive for cities to participate voluntarily. The bill further benefits communities by granting priority access to state housing and infrastructure grants for jurisdictions that adopt ordinances under its provisions, reinforcing a cooperative rather than punitive model of state and local partnership.

SB 06 also draws clear boundaries to protect local authority by affirming that it does not mandate any specific amount of housing production, does not supersede existing zoning authority except where explicitly stated, and does not invite state intervention into local planning decisions. This

clarity is essential to ensuring that cities can continue to plan responsibly and sustainably while contributing to statewide goals in ways that reflect local needs and conditions.

For these reasons, the League of California Cities is pleased to support SB 06 and respectfully urges its passage. We appreciate your leadership on housing policy and look forward to continued collaboration on efforts that advance affordability while strengthening California's diverse communities.

Sincerely,
Cal Sanchez
League of California Cities